

Bedlay Gardens — User Guide

*A complete guide to booking, managing, and running the Bedlay
Gardens online system*

July 2026

Introduction

This guide explains how to use the Bedlay Gardens website and online booking system — for dog owners booking a stay, for staff running day-to-day care, and for admins managing the business. It's organised by who you are, so find your section and start there:

- For Customers — creating an account, adding your dog, booking a stay, and managing your bookings
- For Staff — checking dogs in and out, daily care tasks, van runs, and logging incidents
- For Admins — managing services, pricing, staff, content, and reports
- For Super Admins — the extra tools available to the business owner(s)

Everyone signs in at the same place: bedlaygardens.co.uk/login, using either a password or a one-time email link. What you see after logging in depends on your account type — customers land in the Portal, staff and admins land in their own dashboards.

For Customers

Creating an account

Go to /register and fill in your name, email, and a password (at least 8 characters). You'll also need to give a phone number or a work phone number (at least one is required) and your address — address line 1 is required, the rest is optional. Once submitted, you'll receive a welcome email and be signed in automatically, ready to add your first dog.

Logging in

On the login page you can choose:

- Password — enter your email and password as normal.
- Email link — enter just your email address and we'll send you a one-time sign-in link, no password needed.

Signing the Boarding Agreement

Before you can make any booking, you need to read and sign our current Boarding Agreement, once. You'll be prompted automatically the first time you try to book — just enter your full name and tick "I agree". This creates a signed, dated copy on file. If the agreement is ever updated, you'll be asked to sign the new version before your next booking.

Adding your dog(s)

From Portal > My Dogs, click "Add a dog" and fill in as much as you know:

- Name and breed (required)
- Date of birth, sex, size, and whether they're neutered/spayed
- Weight
- Feeding notes, medication notes, and behaviour notes — these feed directly into staff's daily care tasks, so the more detail the better
- Vet name and phone number, and an emergency contact
- A photo

You can edit any of this later, and each dog's size (Miniature/Small/Medium/Large/Giant) is also what colour-codes them on the admin occupancy calendar.

Vaccination records

Every dog needs valid, in-date vaccination records covering the whole length of a stay before boarding, daycare, or forest walks can be booked. You can add these two ways, from Portal > Vaccinations:

- Upload certificate — drag in a photo or PDF of the certificate and the system reads it automatically, pulling out every vaccine listed (a single certificate often covers several — DHPP,

Leptospirosis, Kennel Cough, Rabies) along with the date given and expiry date for each. You'll see an editable review screen to confirm or correct anything before saving — nothing is saved until you press Save.

- Add vaccination — enter the details yourself: vaccine type, date given, expiry date, and optionally attach the certificate file for reference (this route does not read the file automatically).

Every record starts as Unverified until a staff member checks it against the certificate and marks it Verified (or Expired, if it's out of date). You'll get an email reminder 14 days before any vaccination expires.

Booking a stay

Bedlay Gardens offers five bookable services:

- Meet & Greet — a short supervised introduction, required before any dog's first overnight boarding stay
- Day Care — full day or half day (AM/PM)
- Secure Forest Walks — a timed slot in our securely enclosed woodland
- Home Boarding (overnight) — one or more nights' stay
- Dog Walking — collection and drop-off via a scheduled van run

To book, go to Services or Book Now, choose a service, and step through the booking wizard:

1. Dates — pick your check-in/check-out dates (boarding), a date and Full/Half Day (daycare), a walk slot (forest walks), or a van run plus your pickup address (dog walking). Use "Check availability" to confirm there's space.
2. Dogs — select which of your dogs this booking is for. You can select more than one.
3. Add-ons — (boarding only) tick any extras you'd like, such as extra playtime.
4. Review — check the full price breakdown (base price × nights/dogs, add-ons, total, and deposit), tick "I have read and agree to the Terms & Conditions", and confirm.

Note: If a dog's vaccinations are missing or about to expire, or a required Meet & Greet hasn't happened yet, you'll be stopped and told exactly what's needed before you can continue. Some dogs also carry compatibility flags (e.g. "no shared kennel" or "no group walks") set by staff, which can restrict booking dogs together — you'll be told if this applies.

Once confirmed, you'll land on a confirmation page. If payment is due now (a deposit or the full amount), you'll see a Pay button — for invoice-after services (like dog walking), nothing is due at booking time; you'll be invoiced afterwards instead.

Managing your bookings

Portal > Bookings lists everything you've booked. From here you can:

- Pay an outstanding deposit or balance
- Redeem a voucher code or your account credit against a deposit or balance instead of paying by card
- Cancel a booking — this applies our cancellation policy automatically based on how close the stay is: full refund if cancelled well in advance, deposit forfeit if it's closer, and no refund very close to the stay. You can also add a reason when cancelling.

Subscriptions

For dogs who come regularly, Portal > Subscriptions lets you set up recurring weekly Day Care or Dog Walking — pick the service, the dog, which day(s) of the week, and a preferred time. Daycare subscriptions automatically create a booking a week ahead each time; dog-walking subscriptions are confirmed by staff. You can Pause a subscription until a chosen date, Resume it, or Cancel it entirely at any time.

Waitlist

If Day Care or Meet & Greet is fully booked on the date you want, you'll be offered the option to join the waitlist while checking availability. Portal > Waitlist shows your position and status — when a space frees up, you'll be notified and have a limited time to Claim it before it's offered to the next person in line.

Vouchers & account credit

Portal > Vouchers lets you buy a gift voucher (choose £25/£50/£100 or enter a custom amount between £5 and £1000) — optionally for someone else, by entering their email. Vouchers and any account credit you hold are redeemed from the Bookings page, applied against a specific deposit or balance charge. If a voucher covers more than the charge, the leftover amount is kept as account credit for next time.

Pupdates

While your dog is staying with us, staff post photo and video updates during the visit — Portal > Pupdates shows every update we've shared, each with a note from the team, so you can see how your dog's doing.

Reviews

After a completed stay, Portal > Reviews lets you leave a star rating (1–5) and an optional written review. Reviews are checked by our team before appearing publicly on the website.

Account settings

Portal > Account covers:

- Contact details — name, phone/work phone, and address
- Notification preferences — choose Email, SMS, or Both for updates like pickup/dropoff, balance reminders, and waitlist offers (SMS needs a phone number on file); you can also opt out of abandoned-booking reminder emails separately
- Password — change your password (only shown if you have one set)
- Billing — manage saved cards and view payment history via our secure Stripe billing portal
- Delete account — permanently remove your account; if you have booking history that must be kept for our records, your personal details are anonymised instead of the account being fully deleted

For Staff

Today dashboard

Staff > Today is your daily starting point, showing three lists for overnight boarding and daycare guests:

- Arrivals — bookings starting today, with a Check in button
- Departures — bookings ending today, with a Check out button
- In-house — every dog currently checked in, with their kennel unit and departure date

Each card shows the dog(s), the customer, the service, and any compatibility flag badges (e.g. "no group walks") so you know at a glance what to be aware of.

Checking a dog in

From a booking's Check-in page, you'll see any past incidents on file for the dog as a warning first. Then:

- Tick "belongings confirmed" (required)
- For boarding, optionally reassign to a different kennel unit
- If vaccinations are missing or expired, you'll need to enter an override reason to check the dog in anyway — this is recorded in the audit log

Checking a dog out

The Check-out page shows the total, amount paid, and outstanding balance. You can't complete checkout if there's an outstanding balance, unless the service is invoiced afterwards (like Dog Walking), in which case checking out raises the invoice.

Care Schedule

Staff > Care Schedule generates today's tasks automatically for every in-house dog: a Feed task (using the dog's feeding notes, if set), a Medication task (if medication notes are set), and a Walk task (always). Mark each one done as you complete it, with an optional note — once marked done, it shows who completed it.

Walk Roster

Staff > Walk Roster shows today's Secure Forest Walk sessions, with times, duration, and which dogs are booked into each slot (read-only — for reference while running the walks).

Van Runs

Staff > Van Runs shows today's dog-walking collection runs, stop by stop, in delivery order. For each dog, update their status as you go: Collected, Walked, or Dropped off — marking Collected or Dropped off automatically sends the customer a notification.

Posting Pupdates

Staff > Pupdates lets you post a photo or video update for any currently checked-in dog, with an optional note. This emails the owner immediately and appears in their portal.

Trials (Meet & Greet outcomes)

Staff > Trials lists Meet & Greet visits awaiting an outcome. For each, record: Passed, Needs another visit, or Not suitable, with notes. Passing is what unlocks overnight boarding for that dog — customers can't book boarding until this is recorded.

Logging incidents

Staff > Incidents lets you log anything noteworthy for any in-house dog — a severity level (Low/Medium/High) and a description. Past incidents for a dog automatically show up as a warning the next time that dog is checked in.

Verifying vaccination certificates

Staff > Vaccinations shows every certificate awaiting review (with the uploaded photo/PDF alongside the details customers entered or that were read automatically). Mark each one Verified or Expired — this is what confirms a dog is genuinely cleared to board.

For Admins

Everything in the Staff section above is also available to admins (via the "Staff Portal" link), plus the following business-management tools.

Overview dashboard

Admin > Overview shows four at-a-glance figures, each linking straight to the relevant page: today's accommodation occupancy, today's arrivals, how many vaccination certificates are waiting to be verified, and your total customer count.

Calendar

Admin > Calendar is a month view showing, for each day, how many bookings there are per service — a quick way to see busy periods across all services at once.

Occupancy

Admin > Occupancy shows a visual chart of every accommodation unit (kennel/crate) across the month: each stay is a solid bar spanning its dates, labelled with the dog's name, and coloured by the dog's size (Miniature/Small/Medium/Large/Giant) so you can see capacity at a glance. Each day's column also shows how many pets are on-site that day, and the page header shows the month's overall occupancy percentage. Click any bar to jump straight to that booking.

Bookings

Admin > Bookings lists every booking, searchable by customer name/email and filterable by service and status. From here you can:

- Create a manual booking on a customer's behalf (useful for phone bookings) — this skips the vaccination gate by default, since staff are making the judgement call directly
- Open any booking to record a manual payment, change dates, reassign the kennel unit, or cancel it
- Sign the boarding agreement on a customer's behalf for phone bookings, recording that staff read it aloud and got verbal consent

Waitlist management

Admin > Waitlist shows everyone waiting for a fully-booked date, reorderable and removable, with a manual "offer this spot" action if needed.

Services

Admin > Services is where you manage what's bookable: create or edit a service (name, description, pricing model, base price, payment timing), toggle it active/inactive, or delete it (services with existing bookings are automatically deactivated instead, to preserve history). Within

each service you can also manage:

- Add-ons — extra chargeable items customers can tick during booking
- Peak/seasonal price rules — a date range with either a percentage adjustment or a flat override price, optionally requiring a minimum number of nights

Pricing & Capacity

Admin > Pricing & Capacity covers accommodation units and business-wide settings:

- Accommodation units — add/edit each kennel/crate's name, size label, and dog capacity; deactivate or delete a unit
- Blocked dates — block a specific unit, or the whole site, on chosen dates
- Settings — deposit percentage, balance-due notice period, cancellation policy windows, second-dog discount, day care capacity, and the VAT-enabled toggle

Van Runs (admin)

Admins can create and edit van runs (name, date, start time, dog capacity) the same way staff view and work them on the day.

Staff management

Admin > Staff lists every staff/admin account. Add a new staff member with their name, email, phone, job title, bio, role (Staff or Admin), and a temporary password; edit or deactivate an existing one. Only a super admin can create or edit Admin-level accounts, grant super-admin status, or reset an admin's password (see Super Admin section).

Vaccinations (admin)

The same verification queue available to staff (see "For Staff" above) is also available under Admin > Vaccinations.

Media & Gallery

Admin > Media manages every photo/video on the public site: the homepage gallery (organised into admin-defined categories), the homepage hero image, and photos used on individual service or About-page sections. Upload new media, set captions and alt text, reorder, and delete.

Content

Admin > Content covers the website's editable text and settings:

- Main menu — show or hide individual menu items
- Business email, announcement banner, About page text (story & facility), Terms & Conditions, Vacancies text, and opening hours
- FAQs and Testimonials — add, edit, and remove
- Google Business review link

- VAT details — VAT registration number, rate, and the period start month/length used by the Accounting page (see below)

Customers

Admin > Customers is a searchable list of every customer account. Opening a customer gives you:

- Admin notes (private, staff-only)
- Promote to staff or admin
- Account credit balance, and a form to issue goodwill credit with a reason
- Dog compatibility flags — add or remove flags like "no shared kennel" or "resource guarding", with notes
- Full booking history
- Active/banned toggle
- Permanently delete the customer and all their data (super admin only — see below)

Reviews moderation

Admin > Reviews shows every review awaiting a decision — Approve or Reject each one. Only approved reviews appear on the public site.

Reports

Admin > Reports gives a month-by-month view: occupancy percentage, total revenue, a revenue-by-service breakdown, bookings due to start in the next 7 days, and an Export CSV button for the underlying data.

Accounting

Admin > Accounting is the full financial transaction ledger — every payment (deposit, balance, invoice, refund), showing when it was raised, when it was fully paid, the customer, dog, service, a net/VAT/gross split, the deposit, and any outstanding balance. It's organised by VAT period (using the period length and start month set in Content > VAT details) with Prev/Next navigation, filterable by payment status and customer name, and exportable to CSV. The page header shows the VAT collected for the selected period.

Note: VAT is only split out once "VAT enabled" is switched on under Pricing & Capacity, and the rate used is always the current one set in Content > VAT details — the system doesn't keep a historical record of past rates, so changing the rate changes how older transactions are displayed too.

Super Admin — Additional Capabilities

A super admin is an Admin account with an extra flag granting a small number of sensitive, business-critical powers. There can be at most two super admins at a time. Everything below is on top of full Admin access.

Audit Log

Admin > Audit Log (only visible to super admins — it doesn't appear in the menu, or exist as a page, for anyone else) is a complete record of every significant action taken across the whole system: logins, customer/dog/vaccination creation, bookings created and cancelled, payments confirmed, and every admin change (settings, staff, pricing, content, and more). Each entry shows who did it, what, and exactly when.

You can filter by:

- Date range (from/to)
- Category — Logins, Dogs, Bookings, or Customers
- Staff name or customer ID
- A free-text search across the action and its details

Export the filtered results as CSV (for spreadsheets) or JSON (for other tools).

Deleting a customer

From a customer's detail page, a super admin can permanently delete the account and everything tied to it — every dog, booking, and payment record — after a confirmation dialog that names exactly what will be removed. This cannot be undone.

Managing admin accounts

Only a super admin can:

- Create or edit an Admin-level account
- Grant or remove another account's super-admin status (maximum two at a time, and you can't remove the last remaining super admin)
- Deactivate an Admin account or reset an admin's password
- Promote a customer directly to Admin (any admin can promote a customer to Staff, but only a super admin can promote to Admin)

Note: Super admins are deliberately kept out of the public website — they don't appear in the "Our team" section on the About page, or in the regular Staff list that other admins see.

Reference

Roles at a glance

- Customer — books and manages their own dogs, bookings, and account
- Staff — runs day-to-day operations: check-in/out, care tasks, van runs, pupdates, trials, incidents, vaccination verification
- Admin — everything Staff can do, plus managing services, pricing, staff, content, customers, and reports
- Super Admin — an Admin with extra powers: audit log, permanent customer deletion, and managing other admin accounts (maximum two super admins at any time)

Booking statuses

- Draft — started but not completed
- Pending Payment — booked, awaiting deposit/payment
- Confirmed — deposit or payment received
- Checked In / Checked Out — during and after the stay
- Completed — stay finished and fully settled
- Cancelled by Customer / Cancelled by Admin — cancelled, with a reason and timestamp recorded
- No Show — customer didn't arrive

Payment types & statuses

Types: Deposit, Balance, Invoice, Refund. Statuses: Pending, Succeeded, Failed, Refunded.

Vaccination statuses

- Unverified — added by the customer, not yet checked by staff
- Verified — confirmed against the certificate by a staff member
- Expired — past its expiry date

Automatic emails

- Welcome email — on registering a new account
- Booking confirmation — when a deposit is paid, or immediately for invoice-after services
- Payment receipt — every time a deposit or balance payment succeeds
- Balance-due reminder — a few days before a balance payment is due
- Check-in reminder — the day before a stay begins
- Vaccination expiry warning — 14 days before a vaccination record expires
- Pupdate notification — whenever staff post a photo/video update
- Waitlist offer — when a spot becomes available for someone on the waitlist
- Review request — a day or so after checkout, if no review has been left yet
- Voucher delivery — when a gift voucher purchase completes

- Abandoned booking reminder — two follow-ups if a booking is started but never paid for
- Cancellation confirmation — when a booking is cancelled, including the refund policy that applied

Customers control how they receive these (Email, SMS, or Both) from Portal > Account, and can separately opt out of abandoned-booking reminders.